

History Battlefield Tour

Ypres & The Salient



Meoncross School – Battlefield Tour

Name: _____

Tutor Group: _____

Day 0: Pre-Trip Information

What to Pack & Logistics

What to Pack: The Essential Checklist

Please ensure all pupils have the following items packed in a suitable overnight bag (no hard suitcases if possible, to maximize coach storage space):

- **Valid Passport** (handed to staff on the morning of departure)
- **GHIC / EHIC Card** (valid and in-date)
- **Sturdy Walking Boots** or waterproof shoes (we will be walking through muddy trenches)
- **Waterproof Coat** (Belgian weather is unpredictable)
- **Small Rucksack** for daytime use on the coach
- **Euro Currency** (approx €30-€50 maximum for snacks and chocolates)
- **Refillable Water Bottle**

Time	Activity / Location	Details
10th Sep	Parent Briefing Meeting	16:15 in the School Hall. Attendance is highly recommended to receive final itineraries and ask any questions.

Day 1: Thursday 1st October 2026

Travel and Initial Explorations

Introduction

Today we travel to Belgium to begin our exploration of the Ypres Salient. The itinerary is packed with important historical sites.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
06:15	Departure from School	Travel via Jet Connect executive coach to Folkestone.
09:00	Folkestone Eurotunnel Terminal	Check-in and security boarding.
11:20	Eurotunnel Crossing	Transit to Calais (clocks go forward 1 hour).
13:00	Depart Calais	Coach journey to the Ypres Salient.
14:30	Essex Farm Cemetery & Dressing Station	Historical introduction to wartime medical care and Commonwealth war graves.
15:15	Langemarck German Military Cemetery	Guided visit exploring the contrasting design of German burial sites.
16:00	Hooze Crater Museum & Trenches	Museum visit focusing on First World War artefacts, preserved trenches, and field medicine.
17:45	Arrival at Peace Village	Accommodation check-in and safety briefing.
18:15	Evening Meal	Dinner followed by room allocation and settling in.
19:15	Study & Reflection Session	Guided review and workbook completion.
20:15	Supervised Free Time	Downtime in communal areas.

Day 2: Friday 2nd October 2026

Immersive Battlefield Study

Overview

Today is a full day of guided study across the Ypres Salient, concluding with the Last Post Ceremony at the Menin Gate.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
08:00	Breakfast	Provided at accommodation.
09:00	Depart for Battlefield Sites	Board coach for full day of guided study.
09:15	The Brooding Soldier	Visit to the Canadian memorial at St Julien (First Gas Attack, 1915).
09:45	Sanctuary Wood & Preserved Trenches	Exploration of original trench systems (sturdy footwear advised).
11:30	Supervised Lunch Stop	Stop in Ypres to purchase packed lunch and snacks.
13:00	Tyne Cot British Cemetery	Guided visit to the world's largest Commonwealth war cemetery.
14:15	Lijssenthoek Visitors Centre & Cemetery	Study of casualty clearing stations and battlefield medicine.
15:45	Passchendaele Museum (Zonnebeke)	Immersive museum tour and dugout experience.
17:30	Return to Peace Village	Downtime and preparation for evening event.
18:00	Evening Meal	Dinner at accommodation.

Day 3: Saturday 3rd October 2026

Poperinge and the Journey Home

Departure

Our final day involves exploring the town of Poperinge, an important rest center for British soldiers, before beginning our journey home.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
08:00	Breakfast & Packing	Breakfast, room handover, and loading coach.
09:15	Menin Gate & Ramparts Walk	Daytime study of memorial panels and walk to Ypres Ramparts Cemetery.
10:30	Ypres Town Square	Supervised visit to a traditional Belgian chocolatier.
11:20	Talbot House, Poperinge	Tour of the famous British soldiers' rest house and club.
12:45	Lunch in Poperinge	Supervised lunch stop in the town centre.
13:30	Poperinge Town Hall	Visit to preserved death cells and military justice sites.
14:30	Depart for Calais	Return journey to Eurotunnel terminal.
17:50	Eurotunnel Crossing	Calais to Folkestone (arrives 17:30 UK time).
20:00 approx.	Return to School	Arrival back at Meoncross School for collection.

My Reflections: Day 3: Saturday 3rd October 2026

